

Fina's Story

My name is Fina. I was born by the sea. I love the sea. I live with my parents and a few relatives.

One day, I noticed a large house by the **seashore**.

“What is that, Ma?” I asked in **wonder**.

“It’s called a resort, Fina. It’s a place where the people who come to visit the beach can stay.”

Many people came to stay at the resort. Their children played with a variety of toys. I was **often tempted** to play with them but my mother never let me play with strangers. So I used to watch them from my hiding place.

They would leave all kinds of things — plastic packets, umbrellas, bottles, and sometimes even toys on the beach. The elders would get very angry and **sigh** with **annoyance**, “What a **nuisance**!”

Once, when there was no one on the beach, I found a bright, shiny toy and picked it up.

“Fina! Why are you touching those things?” my mother asked, **scolding** me **anxiously**.

“What if it carries some disease or poison?”

I was very **ashamed** of myself. I had not thought about **falling ill** because of the toy.

To my surprise, after scolding me, my mother let me keep the toy. I really enjoyed playing with it.



A few days later, I noticed that mother looked unwell. “Ma, what’s wrong?” I asked her.

Mother answered with a lot of difficulty, “I don’t feel very well, Fina.”

My father and the other relatives were away. My mother soon began to **writhe** in pain. I felt helpless. There were a boy and a girl playing on the beach. I decided to **approach** them.

“Don’t be afraid, Ma. I’m going to get help for you!” I said and made my way to the beach.

I heard my mother **call out** in her pain, “Fina, don’t!”

As I approached the couple of kids, I realized that my mother had followed me.

The girl saw me first. She **tugged** at the boy’s hand and said, “Hey Prince, look!”

The smiles on their faces reassured me a little. I **summoned up** some courage and said, “Will you help me? There’s no one at home and my mother is very sick.”

One look at my mother and they understood that she was unwell.

“My name is Pinki,” said the girl to me, “and this is my brother Prince. Why don’t you wait here with your mother while we get help?”

They ran as fast as they could and soon returned with a couple of people. The men put my mother on a stretcher and took her away. My eyes filled with tears as I stood there watching.



Pinki and Prince came to me and said, “Don’t worry, our father is a doctor. Your mother will be fine soon!”

Their innocent faces and **soothing** smiles reduced my fears **considerably**. I looked at them and returned their smile. Reassured by the fact that my mother would recover, I joined them in their play. It was a lot of fun.

My father and other relatives were not at all happy when they returned. They were angry with me. But my old and **wise** grandpa **shook his head** and said, “You cannot blame her! She is only a child and she did what she thought was best! Let us wait and see how things go.”

It took almost an entire month for my mother to get better. Pinki and Prince kept me informed of her condition regularly. Even their parents would come to talk to me and reassure me. Children were not allowed in the hospital so I couldn't visit my mother, and the others didn't trust the resort people so they refused to go.

The day my mother returned was a happy day for me! She hugged me and said, “Thank you, Fina, for being so brave when I was sick. Otherwise, I don't think I would have survived. Our methods of treatment are **by no means** as advanced as theirs! But then, they were the reason why I fell ill in the first place!”

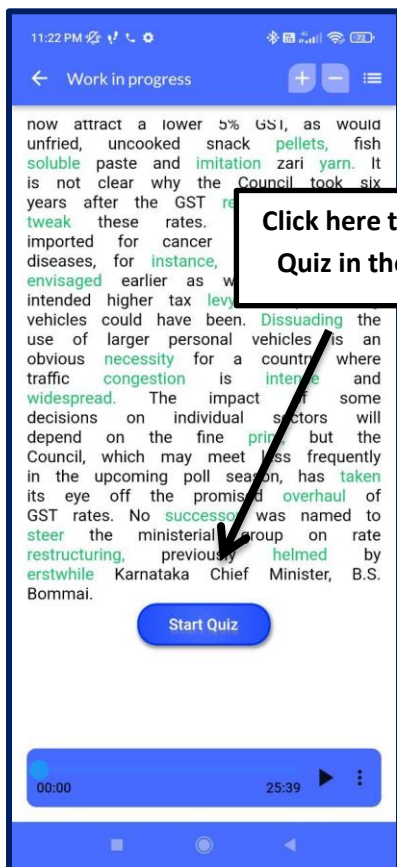
Actually, my mother had fallen ill because she had eaten a plastic bottle thinking it was a fish! Plastic bottles often look like fish to us. We eat fish all the time. We eat them **raw**. Uh oh! I forgot to mention that we are not people like you. We are creatures of the sea. In your world, we are known as dolphins.

Vocabulary

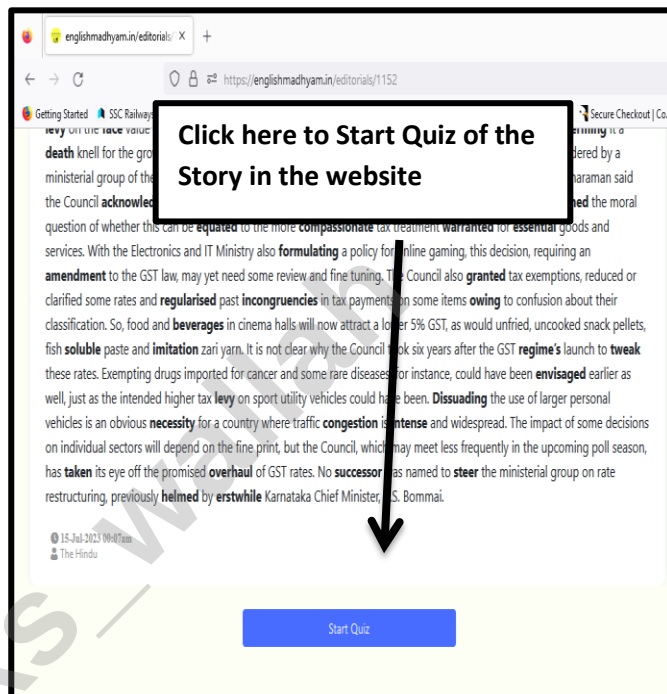
1. **Seashore** (noun) – coast, beach, shoreline, waterfront, littoral – समुद्र तट
2. **Wonder** (noun) – amazement, awe, admiration, curiosity, surprise – आश्चर्य
3. **Often** (adverb) – frequently, regularly, repeatedly, commonly, usually – अक्सर
4. **Tempt** (to) (verb) – lure, attract, entice, provoke, coax – ललचाना
5. **Sigh** (noun) – exhale, breath, gasp, puff, suspiration – आह / लंबी सांस
6. **Annoyance** (noun) – irritation, displeasure, vexation, bother, nuisance – चिड़चिड़ापन
7. **Nuisance** (noun) – irritation, annoyance, problem, bother, inconvenience – उपद्रव / झंझट
8. **Scold** (verb) – reprimand, rebuke, chide, berate, admonish – डांटना
9. **Anxiously** (adverb) – nervously, worriedly, restlessly, fearfully, tensely – चिंता से
10. **Ashamed** (of) (adjective) – embarrassed, guilty, regretful, remorseful, humiliated – शर्मिदा
11. **Fall ill** (phrase) – become sick, get unwell, catch a disease, suffer, be indisposed – बीमार पड़ना
12. **Writhe** (verb) – squirm, twist, thrash, struggle, flail – तड़पना
13. **Approach** (verb) – come near, reach, move toward, advance, draw closer – पास जाना / संपर्क करना
14. **Call out** (phrasal verb) – shout, cry, exclaim, yell, announce – चिल्लाना / पुकारना
15. **Tug** (verb) – pull, drag, yank, jerk, haul – खींचना
16. **Summon up** (phrasal verb) – gather, muster, collect, call forth, generate – हिम्मत जुटाना
17. **Soothing** (adjective) – calming, comforting, relaxing, pacifying, gentle – शांत करने वाला
18. **Considerably** (adverb) – significantly, greatly, markedly, notably, largely – काफी हद तक
19. **Wise** (adjective) – intelligent, sensible, insightful, judicious, prudent – बुद्धिमान
20. **Shake one's head** (phrase) – express refusal, disagree, negate, decline, deny – सिर हिलाकर मना करना
21. **By no means** (phrase) – not at all, in no way, absolutely not, never, under no circumstance – किसी भी तरह से नहीं
22. **Raw** (adjective) – uncooked, fresh, unprocessed, natural, unrefined – कच्चा

@mocks_wallah

Practice Exercise



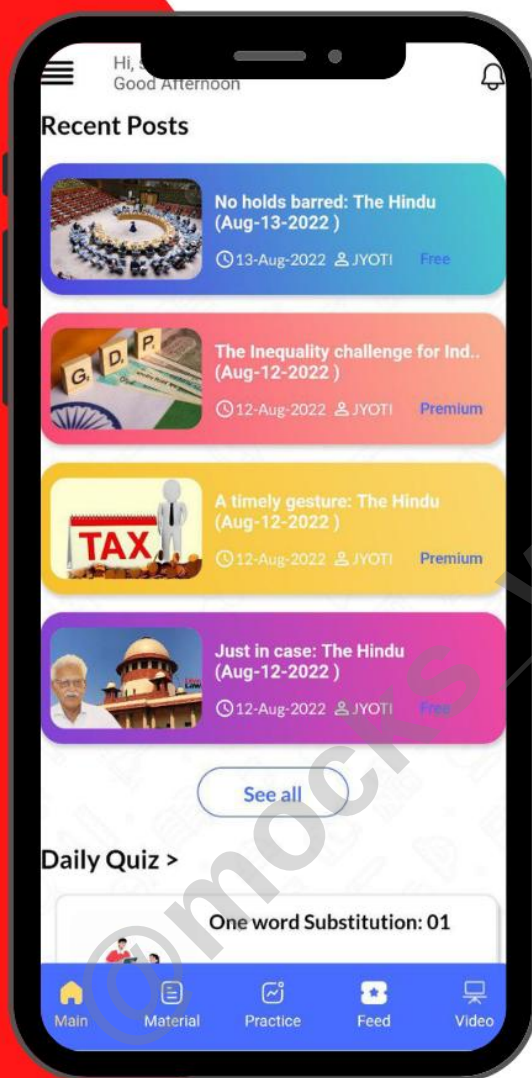
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